

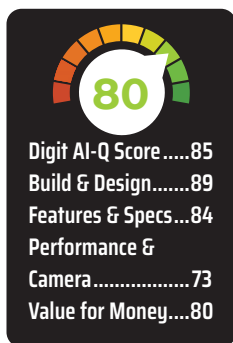
Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6

Refined and sophisticated, but does it warrant the price hike?

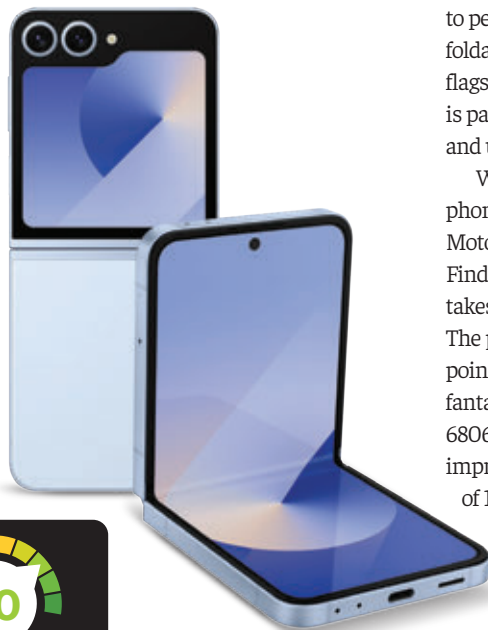
The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 has entered the 2024 foldable market with an array of improvements. The battery capacity has increased, the IP rating now includes some level of dust protection, the main camera has been upgraded, the phone houses the latest and greatest Snapdragon SoC, and it features a host of new Galaxy AI features. The phone has certainly been refined further, but it doesn't boast too many generational upgrades. Additionally, Motorola recently disrupted the market with its Moto Razr 50 Ultra, and OPPO has a compelling offering in the OPPO Find N3 Flip. Will the Galaxy Z Flip6 stand out among these options, especially considering the price has been increased by ₹10,000?

BUILD AND DESIGN

The design hasn't seen any major changes compared to its predecessor, but there have been some subtle improvements. The phone is marginally thinner when folded, but the difference is negligible – 14.9 mm on the Z Flip6 versus 15.1 mm on last year's Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5. The battery capacity has increased from 3,700 mAh to 4,000 mAh. Samsung has added accent rings around the cameras this time around that are colour-matched to the rear panel of the device, giving it an extra bit of flair. One major improvement for me is the appearance of the crease. It doesn't look as pronounced as in previous generations of Galaxy Flips and I usually can't notice it when the display is turned on, except in studio lighting. The Z Flip6 is IP48 rated, meaning dust particles larger than 1 mm cannot get into the innards of the phone. This is a good thing since the Galaxy Z Flip5 had no official protection against dust.



₹1,09,999



DISPLAY(S)

The displays remain largely unchanged on the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6; the brightness levels have gone up from 1,750 nits of peak brightness to 2,600 nits, but that's about it. These are still gorgeous-looking displays with good colour reproduction and viewing angles. They support HDR10+ but not Dolby Vision, yet HDR content looks rich and vivid in OTT apps such as Netflix and YouTube. Brightness levels are also high enough for comfortable usage in harsh sunlight. I got a reading of 1,368 nits on HBM under direct sunlight, which is great.

The bezels of the inner display are a bit too thick for my liking; Samsung really needs to trim these down. Regarding the functionality of the cover display, there are a lot of widgets you can add to it and you can use Gemini on the cover screen if you wish to, but app functionality is quite limited until you download Good Lock, which

allows you to run pretty much any app on the cover screen. It's a shame it's not available by default like on the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra.

PERFORMANCE AND UI

The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 may have fallen slightly behind in the cover screen department, but it shines when it comes to performance. It is the most powerful flip foldable available in India, powered by the flagship Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chipset. This is paired with 12 GB of LPDDR5X RAM and up to 512 GB of UFS 4.0 storage.

When compared to other flip smartphones in the market, such as the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra and the OPPO Find N3 Flip, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 takes the crown in synthetic benchmarks. The phone scores a whopping 1.7 million points in AnTuTu v10 and achieves a fantastic score of 2165 in Single-Core and 6806 in Multi-Core in GeekBench. It also impresses in PCMark Work with a score of 17,739. Whether for productivity tasks or general day-to-day usage, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 is capable of handling them smoothly.

In GPU benchmarks, the Z Flip6 dominates once again, even outperforming its cousin, the Galaxy Z Fold6, in the GFXBench tests. However, the phone does throttle considerably under stressful loads. In the CPU Throttling Test, the Z Flip6 throttled to 69 per cent of its peak performance in just 15 minutes.

When performing intensive tasks such as playing games or rendering videos, you may notice the phone slowing down slightly due to throttling after a certain period. This was evident while playing Genshin Impact, where the phone's frame rates started dipping after half an hour of gameplay. However, surface temperatures didn't rise too much mainly due to the new vapour chamber cooling system on the Z Flip6.

As for the UI, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 comes with Android 14 out of the box, with One UI 6.1.1 on top. The phone will receive seven years of OS and security updates, which is category-leading. One UI is a joy to use; it is extremely refined and packed with useful features. Bloatware is kept to a minimum, though it's not as